

Antec Three Hundred

Honey, I Shrunk The Nine Hundred

Antec is an equally well-known brand as Cooler Master and the rest. We have already tested one of their entry-level cases – the NSK4400. The Antec Three Hundred is a more robust and well-built case.

The body design is somewhat like the Antec Nine Hundred, but is a little simpler looking. There are two fans – one at the top and one at the rear. Both fans have throttle control switches to control their speed. Two more fans can be added to the front and one to the side of cabinet. The cabinet doesn't come with an inbuilt power supply, and when you do buy a power supply, you will find that it fits into the bottom of the case.

The doors on the case open outwards instead of sliding backwards first like on normal cabinets.

The cabinet is undoubtedly sturdier than the majority of entry-level cabinets. The case itself doesn't rattle too much, and the panels aren't the heaviest, but they're still very good.

However, this isn't as feature-laden, refined or as tough as some of the slightly costlier but well-known cabinets like the Cooler Master 690 for example. There are plenty of thumbscrews supplied along with the case itself although there are no locking mechanisms for the cards installed, or even for the drives.

Six hard drives can be installed inside this cabinet, and there is space for three optical drives. The cabinet has two USB ports, the audio connectors and the power and reset switches on the top of the cabinet.



At a price of Rs 3,600, this is something that people could consider, but without a power supply, we feel it's a little over-priced. You should be able to find competing products that are a tad more expensive, but with more features and better build quality.

Specifications:
Dimensions: 45.8 x 46.5 x 20.5 cm, Weight: 8.5 kg

Contact: Cyber Space Abacus Pvt Ltd
Phone: 044-24512288
E-mail: sales@antecindia.com
Web site: www.antecindia.com
Price: Rs 3,600

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Belkin Laptop Cooling Pad

Fancy, But Works Well

The Belkin laptop cooler has a fresh and unique looking design that is made to be practical. It is built rather well and doesn't come with a metal body to absorb heat like the others we've seen from its competitors.

Even though it has a plastic body, it is still pretty well built. It is smooth, shaped well and has two strips of rubber-like grips at the top and bottom of the upper surface of the platform. This is to help your laptop stay in place. The bottom has a grip to stop it from

sliding around on your table. In terms of size, it is good even for something as small as the new range of netbooks we've seen from some of the brands. We tried the 10-inch EeePC and it all fits together very well.

The fan, unfortunately, has no throttle control, so

you're left with one single full-speed setting. The fan itself is quiet, but it vibrates a little. The lowest point on the laptop is at the same level as the fan itself. This simply means, that the fan is blocked by what ever surface you place it on. This causes the fan to slow down and make a little more noise. Fortunately, the stand at the rear of the laptop allows you to incline the

laptop towards yourself. This also gives the fan some breathing space.

The other flap at the bottom opens up into a small compartment that can be used to store the small USB cable supplied with it.



This is the same cable that will power the fan on the cooler.

We would have loved to see more out of this cooler especially USB ports and the throttle dial. At Rs 2,299, it is pretty expensive, but it's perfect for those who have good looking hardware and want a laptop cooler that looks good and works as well.

Contact: Belkin Asia Pacific Limited
Phone: 9810889785
E-mail: MadhuJ@belkin.com
Web site: www.belkin.in
Price: Rs 2,299

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Microsoft Sidewinder X6

Keys, And More Keys

One might assume that there are only one or two big names that are making great gaming keyboards, and Microsoft doesn't want to be left behind. After reviving the Sidewinder brand, they've released the all new X6 keyboard.

The X6 is a really huge keyboard, and it has plenty of keys as well. The quality could be better, but the design is not shabby. The first things you notice other than the dials is the red backlight. The first dial is there to allow you to change the brightness of the lights, and the other is for the volume control.

The keyboard has a matte plastic finish, except

for the areas around the keys. The keys themselves don't go deep into the keyboard, but aren't too shallow like a laptop keyboard either. One of the unique features is the detachable numerical pad which can be attached either on the right or left of the keyboard with the help of a magnetic strip on the side.

Using the keyboard is very confusing in the beginning, and it takes a while if you're upgrading from a standard keyboard. Once you do get used to it, however, it becomes a great stable keyboard to use. There are six macro keys on one side of the keyboard with a toggle to use three different settings for those keys. The



numerical pad keys are also part of the macro keys.

There are a few other things missing in the X6. The right Windows key is missing and the size of some of the keys like the right [Shift] key are longer than usual. The drivers will let you customise it further.

Overall, this is a very good keyboard for gaming use. Although Rs 4,480 may seem like a lot of money for a keyboard, with the number of features it has, it's definitely worth it.

Besides, this is far from the most expensive keyboard around.

Specifications:
Detachable numpad, up to 30 programmable keys
Contact: Microsoft Hardware
Phone: 9886328580
E-mail: geethakb@microsoft.com
Web site: www.microsoft.com/india/edd/
Price: Rs 4,480

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Samsung T190

A 19-inch Bordeaux?

The Samsung T910 seems to be influenced by the Bordeaux line. The design, especially the transparent bezel surrounding the screen, gave us this impression. The whole body is glossy, and there is a neat little touch-sensitive power button at the bottom. There is a strip of of red at the

bottom and overall it is a very pretty screen to have.

As far as specifications go, there is no differentiator between this or any other 19-inch, and it has a maximum resolution of 1440 x 900.

The stand is sturdy, but offers no flexibility in terms of moving the screen about or rotating it. All the controls are mounted on the right side of the screen which makes it difficult to control the menus and features. The buttons are pretty clunky too. There are plenty of controls that allow you to alter the intensity of colours separately. Samsung has

put in features such as MagicBright that allows brightness and contrast pre-sets to be used.

With all the enhancements turned off, the usual sequences of tests were run on the screen. Colour rendition was average and banding was visible through the Displaymate test. Movies don't look extremely good either.

The screen comes with both VGA and DVI support, and there is a panel behind to hide the mess of cables.

All in all, this screen is for those to whom great aesthetics and design are more important than performance. Since this isn't close to the best, or worst, performer amongst the 19-inch screens we've seen, it isn't all that bad. Its pricing of Rs 13,000

is a lot though, even if it's Bordeaux-inspired, considering that you can get a much larger screen for around this price.

Specifications:
Maximum resolution: 1440 x 900, TN Panel, Response time: 2 ms, Inputs: DVI, DVI-Sub (analog)

Contact: Samsung India Electronics Pvt. Ltd
Phone: 011-41511234
E-mail: rengith.nair@samsung.com
Web site: www.samsung.com
Price: Rs 13,000

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

